

Lab: Collective Sensing Exercise

Objectives

Learning Goal: Practice structured collective perception — eliciting independent observations, aggregating them, and comparing to group discussion results.

Part 1: Individual Observation (10 min, independent)

Read the scenario provided by the instructor (or choose a current ambiguous business situation). Record your observations independently — before any group discussion.

Scenario: _____

Dimension	Your Individual Observation
Key facts you noticed	
Your interpretation of what's happening	
Most important signal	
What's uncertain	
Your recommended action	

Write your response here



Part 2: Collective Aggregation (15 min, group)

Without discussion, share individual observations. Record the distribution:

Dimension	Member 1	Member 2	Member 3	Member 4	Pattern
Key facts					
Interpretation					
Most important signal					
Uncertainty					
Recommendation					

What do individual observations have in common? Where do they diverge?

Write your response here

Part 3: Group Discussion (15 min)

Now discuss as a group. Track how the discussion changes perceptions:

Question	Observation
Did the group converge on one interpretation?	
Was any individual's unique observation incorporated?	
Did anchoring occur (first speaker dominated)?	
Was any observation lost in the discussion?	

Write your response here

Part 4: Comparison (10 min)

Metric	Individual Average	Group Discussion Result	Superior?
Breadth of signals			
Accuracy of interpretation			
Action quality			

Did the structured elicitation (Parts 1-2) add value over direct group discussion (Part 3)?

Write your response here

Summary

Finding	Detail
Key benefit of structured elicitation	
Key risk of unstructured discussion	
What unique information would have been lost without individual elicitation	